

# SHOKKER PAINT BOOTH

## Getting Started Guide

Comprehensive user reference · v6.3.0-alpha "Spring Catalogue"  
Paint the paint. Not the pixel.

A true onboarding guide for the main Paint Booth and companion labs: **Finish Viewer**, **Spec Sculpt**, and **Shokk Drop**. Use the PDF **Bookmarks** panel (left sidebar in Adobe Reader / Edge) or the clickable Table of Contents to jump between parts.

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# Part 0 — Start Here

Read this part once. It matches what the app actually shows on first launch.

## What Shokker Paint Booth Is

SPB finishes iRacing liveries. You load a paint file, tell the app which pixels belong to which **zone**, assign a **finish** (chrome, candy, carbon, COLORSHOXX, etc.) to each zone, and hit **RENDER**. The engine writes both the color TGA and the spec map iRacing expects.

- **Not Photoshop** — build logos and layout in Photoshop; use SPB for materials, gloss, flake, and spec.
- **2,400+ finishes** — bases, patterns, monolithics, and spec-overlay patterns.
- **Zone-level control** — one panel chrome, the next matte red, side by side.
- **Companion labs** (header buttons): Finish Viewer, Spec Sculpt, Shokk Drop — covered later in this guide.

## Your First 15 Minutes (Do This First)

This path matches the in-app guided tour. No labs, no save files — just paint → zone → finish → render.

- **1. Load paint.** Header → **Import PSD** (recommended) or browse a TGA. First launch may already show the demo Chevy truck paint.
- **2. Enter your iRacing User ID** in the header (4–7 digits). Set your **iRacing Car Folder** output path.
- **3. Click a zone** in the left list — you already have **10 default zones** (Body Color 1–4, Car Number, Custom Art 1–2, Sponsors, Open Zone 9, Everything Else). Do not click + Add Zone unless you need an extra slot.
- **4. Define what pixels the zone covers.** With the zone selected, use the **ZONE POPOUT PANEL** (floating panel): quick-color chips, eyedropper on canvas (Pick Color tool), or Magic Wand. Each zone card shows a hint explaining its purpose.
- **5. Assign a finish.** In the popout, open the **BASE** section → click the **Base swatch dropdown** (shows “Select base...” or current finish name). Pick a finish from the picker that opens. **Do not use the Finish Library on the right panel to assign finishes to zones.**
- **6. Repeat** for other zones you care about. Delete unused body-color slots (× on zone card) if single-color.
- **7. Check preview.** Use the preview pane; press **F5** or Refresh if it stalls.
- **8. RENDER.** Click the big **RENDER** button. Confirm car <id>.taa and car spec <id>.taa land in your output folder.

*Tip: Zone 10 “Everything Else” is pre-set to catch unclaimed pixels with a gloss base — keep it at the bottom of the stack.*

## Paint + Spec + Zones

- **Paint file** — PSD (layers) or flat TGA/PNG on the canvas.
- **Zone** — named slot that maps pixels → finish. Top zones win over lower ones.
- **Finish** — material recipe (base + optional pattern + spec). Assigned via popout Base swatch.
- **Spec map** — second TGA iRacing uses for metallic/roughness/clearcoat. SPB generates it on render.

# Part I — Setup

Before you render, these header fields must be correct.

## Header: ID, Paint Path, Output Folder

| Field              | What it does                                                        |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| iRacing User ID    | Your member number — used in output filenames (car_23371.tga)       |
| Source Paint       | Path to PSD/TGA/PNG; Import PSD button for layered files            |
| iRacing Car Folder | Where RENDER writes car_*.tga — browse to your iRacing paint folder |

Header also has: **RENDER**, lab buttons (Finish Viewer / Spec Sculpt / Shokk Drop), **Import Recipe**, **Commands** menu, and **Settings** (gear).

## Loading Your Paint (PSD vs TGA)

| Format                  | When to use                                                              |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PSD (Import PSD button) | Primary workflow — keeps Numbers, Sponsors, Car Paint as separate layers |
| TGA / PNG               | Flat paint, quick tests, or when PSD unavailable                         |

After PSD import, the right panel lists layers (Wire, Mask, Numbers, Sponsors, Car Paint, etc.). Layer names power the **Restrict to Layer** dropdown in the zone popout.

## Settings (Gear Menu)

- **License** — activate Payhip key or early-access code.
- **Auto-Deploy to iRacing** — copy each render straight to iRacing folder (Live Link).
- **Import Spec Map (Merge Mode)** — merge external spec TGA into output.
- **Car File Naming** — custom number options if needed.
- **LOOKS** — shop theme presets (cosmetic only).

# Part II — Interface

Know the four work areas.

## Where Everything Lives

| Area        | Location             | Purpose                                           |
|-------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Header      | Top                  | ID, paths, RENDER, labs, settings                 |
| Zones list  | Left                 | 10 default zone cards — click to select           |
| Zone popout | Floating             | COLOR, BASE, pattern, spec — assign finishes HERE |
| Toolbar     | Far left             | Pick Color, Wand, Brush, Include/Exclude, etc.    |
| Canvas      | Center               | Your paint; eyedropper and region tools           |
| Preview     | Center-right         | Live rendered car view                            |
| Layers list | Right                | PSD layer visibility — not for finish assignment  |
| RENDER      | Canvas area / header | Generates final TGAs                              |

## Left Panel — The 10 Default Zones

On every fresh session SPB creates these zones automatically:

| #   | Name             | Typical use                                             |
|-----|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| 1–4 | Body Color 1–4   | Primary/secondary body colors — delete extras if unused |
| 5   | Car Number       | Number panel colors                                     |
| 6–7 | Custom Art 1–2   | Stripes, accents, custom graphics                       |
| 8   | Sponsors / Logos | Sponsor regions                                         |
| 9   | Open Zone 9      | Spare slot before catch-all                             |
| 10  | Everything Else  | Remaining pixels — pre-set gloss safety net             |

- Each card: rename, solo (■), reorder (▲▼), duplicate (■), delete (×).
- **Restore All** — resets all 10 defaults (keeps finishes on matching names where possible).
- **+ Add Zone** — only if you need more than 10.
- Click a zone card → popout opens for that zone.

## Zone Popout Panel (Your Control Center)

Labeled **ZONE POPOUT PANEL** at the top. This is where you work — not the right-side Finish Library.

■ **Assign finishes by clicking the Base swatch dropdown in this panel. The Finish Library panel on the right is for browsing/reference — do not use it as your primary assign path.**

- Header row: Auto-name, copy/paste zone, Solo, Reset, ■ SHOKK ME.
- **COLOR** — which pixels (quick chips, hex, tolerance, Hard Edge, Draw box, Lasso).
- **BASE** — finish assignment via swatch dropdown ■.
- Below BASE (after a finish is set): Base Color mode, HSB sliders, Pattern, Spec stack, overlays.
- Sections below BASE stay hidden until you pick a base or monolithic — that is normal.

## Right Panel — Layers (Not Finishes)

After PSD import this shows your layer stack: Wire, Mask, Numbers, Sponsors, Car Paint, etc.

- Click a layer to select it for **Layer mode** drawing tools.
- Toggle visibility, opacity, blend mode per layer.
- Double-click → Layer Effects (shadow, stroke, glow).
- Use **Restrict to Layer** in zone popout to limit a zone to one layer's pixels.
- The collapsible Finish Library on the right is optional browse — **assign finishes through the zone popout Base swatch**.

# Part III — Core Workflow

The four steps every livery goes through.

## Step 1: Tell Each Zone Which Pixels

- Select zone in left list → popout opens.
- **Quick colors** — Red, Blue, White, Remaining, etc. (chips in COLOR section).
- **Pick Color tool** (■) — click a pixel on canvas; color adds to zone.
- **Magic Wand** — flood-select by tolerance.
- **Draw box / Lasso** — manual region when color match fails.
- **Tolerance slider** — Exact / Tight / Std / Loose presets + numeric slider.
- **Hard Edge** — on by default; crisp zone boundaries.

## Step 2: Assign Finishes (Popout Only)

In ZONE POPOUT → BASE section → click the **Base** row swatch (name + ■ arrow).

- Picker opens with search, #hashtag filters, Favorites, Grouped view.
- Choose a **base** (gloss, chrome, matte...) or a **monolithic** (COLORSHOXX, MORTAL SHOKK).
- Click a finish → it applies to the active zone; popout expands with more controls.
- Pattern: second swatch row in popout (below base controls).
- Spec patterns: stack section in popout for per-channel M/R/CC overlays.
- **Intensity** — strength preset dropdown in popout after base assigned.

■ **Again: do not assign zone finishes from the right-panel Finish Library tab. Always use the popout Base swatch — same catalog, correct workflow.**

## Step 3: Restrict to Layer (When Needed)

If the same color appears on multiple layers, restrict the zone so it only paints one layer.

- Popout → COLOR section → **RESTRICT TO LAYER** dropdown (visible when PSD loaded).
- Example: Car Number zone → restrict to **Numbers** layer.
- Sponsors zone → restrict to **Sponsors** layer.
- Without restriction, a yellow pixel on Numbers AND Stripes both get the finish.

## Step 4: Preview, Then RENDER

- Preview pane updates as zones change — same engine as final render.
- **F5** or Refresh button if preview hangs.
- Channel buttons: Combined spec, Metallic, Roughness, Clearcoat diagnostics.
- **RENDER** — writes 2048² car\_<id>.tga + car\_spec\_<id>.tga.
- Enable Auto-Deploy in Settings to copy straight to iRacing folder.
- Reload car in iRacing Paint screen to see updates.

# Part IV — Zone Popout Reference

Section-by-section detail.

## COLOR Section

- Quick color chips + Remaining + Everything special selectors.
- Hex input + Apply button for precise colors.
- Tolerance + Hard Edge checkbox.
- Draw box / Lasso / Refine color for manual masks.
- Apply Area controls for drawn regions.
- Restrict to Layer dropdown (PSD workflow).

## BASE — Swatch Picker

The gold-labeled **Base** row with swatch dot + name + ■ opens the finish catalog picker. This is the primary finish assignment control in the entire app.

- Lock icon — keep base when randomizing (■ SHOKK ME).
- After pick: Base Color mode (source / solid / special / gradient).
- Hue / Saturation / Brightness sliders adjust tint without changing finish identity.
- Base scale, rotation, strength sliders for placement tuning.

## Pattern, Spec Stack & Overlays

- **Pattern swatch** — texture overlay (carbon, weave, noise...).
- **Spec pattern stack** — up to 5 layers affecting M/R/CC independently.
- **2nd–5th base overlays** — additional material layers with blend modes.
- **Manual placement bar** — appears on canvas when adjusting pattern position.
- ■ SHOKK ME — randomize entire zone (fun, not for production).

# Part V — Finishes

What you're picking in the Base swatch dropdown.

## Bases, Patterns, Monolithics, Spec Patterns

| Type         | What it is                                      | Pick via                |
|--------------|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Base         | Foundation material (gloss, chrome, matte...)   | Popout → Base swatch    |
| Pattern      | Texture overlay on base                         | Popout → Pattern swatch |
| Monolithic   | All-in-one (COLORSHOXX, MORTAL SHOKK, PAPERDIE) | Popout → Base swatch    |
| Spec pattern | PBR overlay on M/R/CC channels                  | Popout → Spec stack     |

Monolithics bundle base + pattern + spec in one click — good first choice for dramatic looks.

## How the Finish Picker Works

- Opens from popout Base/Pattern swatch click — search bar, #hashtag chips.
- Grouped / Favorites / Showcase / Best / A-Z sort toggles.
- Click finish → applies and closes (or use Compare in catalog modal for A/B).
- Same catalog powers Finish Viewer lab previews — different entry point.

# Part VI — Spec Maps

What iRacing reads besides color.

## M / R / CC for iRacing

| Channel       | Meaning                 | Remember              |
|---------------|-------------------------|-----------------------|
| R — Metallic  | 0 = paint, 255 = metal  | Chrome = high R       |
| G — Roughness | 0 = mirror, 255 = matte | Lower = shinier       |
| B — Clearcoat | 16 = MAX gloss          | INVERTED — 255 = dull |

## Iron Rules

SPB clamps illegal values on export. Clearcoat 1–15 causes whitewash in-sim — never use. Spec Sculpt and Render both enforce iron rules.

# Part VII — Tools

Left toolbar reference.

## Zone Mode vs Layer Mode

Bottom of canvas area: toggle **Zone** (pressed by default) vs **Layer**. Zone mode: color picking, spatial include/exclude, mask tools affect zones. Layer mode: brush, move, transform affect PSD layers.

## Selection, Draw & Spatial Tools

| Tool              | Key        | Use                       |
|-------------------|------------|---------------------------|
| Pick Color        | P          | Sample pixel → zone color |
| Magic Wand        | W          | Flood by tolerance        |
| Lasso / Rect      | L / O      | Manual selection          |
| Include / Exclude | —          | Add/subtract zone region  |
| Brush / Fill      | B / K      | Paint mask or layer       |
| Move / Transform  | V / Ctrl+T | Layer elements            |

# Part VIII — Render & Deploy

## What RENDER Does

- Composites all visible zones → color TGA.
- Generates matching spec TGA from zone finish settings.
- Shows Render Recipe card with job summary.
- Typical time: a few seconds at 2048².

## Auto-Deploy to iRacing

- Settings → Auto-Deploy to iRacing → On.
- Set iRacing Car Folder to your paint directory.
- Each RENDER atomically writes car + spec TGAs.
- Reload car in iRacing — no restart needed.

# Part IX — Save & Share

After you're comfortable with the core loop.

## .shokk Files & Import Recipe

- **Save SHOKK** — full session (zones, finishes, layers) for backup or sharing.
- **Import Recipe** (header) — load a .shokkerrecipe into zones.
- **Auto-save** — session persists across restarts.
- **.spbdrop** — single finish pack from Shokk Drop (see Part XII).

# Part X — Finish Viewer (Paint Lab)

Optional lab — preview any finish on a spinning ball without a car render.

## Finish Viewer (Paint Lab)

- Open: header **Finish Viewer** button.
- Browse catalog → inspect on sphere with lighting rigs.
- Modules: Live Preview, Spec Doctor, Lighting Sim, Compare, Export QA, Reports.
- Use to audition finishes before picking them in the zone popout Base swatch.
- Does not replace the zone workflow — it previews finishes in isolation.

# Part XI — Spec Sculpt Lab

Paint plate → spec map authoring.

## Spec Sculpt Lab

- Open: header **Spec Sculpt**.
- Drop a paint TGA/PNG → pick Scratch / Catalog / Fusion look → Generate spec TGA.
- Auto-Sculpt, Shokk the World (~20 looks), saved recipes.
- Complements booth: booth assigns finishes to zones; Sculpt builds spec from flat paint.
- Iron rules enforced on export.

# Part XII — Shokk Drop

Art → finish import and sharing.

## Shokk Drop

- Open: header **Shokk Drop**.
- Drop PNG/JPG → Import DNA → Gauntlet validation → Commit.
- Finished imports appear in popout Base picker under SHOKK DROP groups.
- Share via .spbdrop packs; SHOKK THE WORLD generates variant sets.

# Part XIII — Workflows

## Copy-Paste Workflows

### Single-color body + chrome numbers

- Import PSD. Delete Body Color 2–4 and unused art zones.
- Body Color 1: pick body color → popout Base → gloss or candy base.
- Car Number: pick number color → restrict to Numbers layer → monolithic or chrome base.
- Everything Else: leave as catch-all (or delete if all pixels claimed above).
- RENDER.

### Recolor existing TGA

- Load TGA in header. Select zone → pick old color → assign new finish via popout Base.
- Use Remaining on Everything Else to skip unclaimed pixels.

### Spec only from finished paint

- Open Spec Sculpt → drop flat paint → Auto-Sculpt or Shokk the World → Deploy spec TGA.

# Reference

## Keyboard Shortcuts

| Shortcut              | Action                             |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------|
| Ctrl+Z / Ctrl+Shift+Z | Undo / Redo                        |
| Ctrl+R                | Render                             |
| F5                    | Refresh preview                    |
| P / W / B / E         | Pick Color / Wand / Brush / Eraser |
| Ctrl+0 / scroll       | Fit / zoom canvas                  |
| Space + drag          | Pan canvas                         |
| ?                     | Shortcut legend                    |

## Troubleshooting

| Problem                 | Fix                                               |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Finish didn't apply     | Use popout Base swatch — not right-panel library  |
| Wrong region painted    | Add Restrict to Layer in popout COLOR section     |
| Popout empty below Base | Pick a base/monolithic first — sections are gated |
| Preview blank           | Define zone colors; F5; check server status       |
| iRacing old paint       | Reload car in Paint screen; verify output folder  |
| Lost default zones      | Click Restore All in zones panel                  |

## Glossary

| Term        | Meaning                                           |
|-------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Zone        | Named pixel region + finish assignment            |
| Zone popout | Floating panel — assign finishes here             |
| Base swatch | Dropdown in popout BASE row — opens finish picker |
| Monolithic  | One-click bundled finish                          |
| Spec map    | Metallic/Roughness/Clearcoat TGA for iRacing      |
| Remaining   | Selector for unclaimed pixels                     |
| Live Link   | Auto-deploy render to iRacing folder              |

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